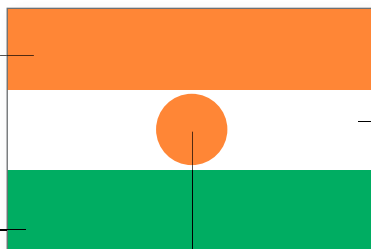


Niger

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** November 23, 1959 **Usage:** National and Civil

Orange represents the savannah grasslands

Green represents the country's rain forests



White represents the River Niger

The orange disc is symbolic of the sun

Africa



Niger was originally a province of French West Africa. In 1958 it joined the Sahel-Benin Union, achieving full independence in 1960.

The flag was designed in 1958 with that of the Ivory Coast, with which Niger was in alliance, along with Chad and Dahomey (modern Benin). This alliance came to nothing, but flags were adopted which indicated their common interest. In the case of Niger, the orange is said to stand for the savannah and the green for the

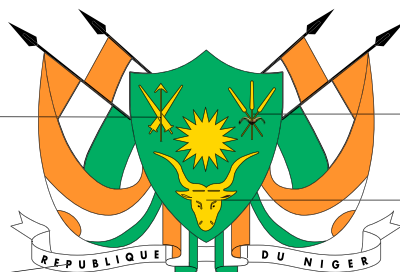
rain forest, whilst the white strip stands for the Niger River, and the orange disc for the sun. The flag was retained on independence and has remained unchanged ever since.

Four flags appear on the arms of Niger, surrounding a green shield. On the shield are weapons, the sun, a corn cob, and a buffalo's head.

ARMS OF NIGER

Weapons represent military achievements

The title of the state—in French—is placed on the scroll



Corn represents the country's agriculture

The buffalo's head reflects pastoral farming